choosing to go on with further education (except for the emergency days of World War II, when the job came hunting me), but now surely that would have to come to an end. What to do?

One avenue opened up with the annual convention of the American Chemical Society, which was to be held in New York in 1947.

The chief activities at such conventions involved the presentation of papers, but in addition there was set up a kind of temporary and concentrated employment bureau. The convention offered prospective employers a dense gathering of young men and women about to leave school, so there was a clearinghouse where students could list their qualifications, and employers their needs. It was to be hoped that happy career marriages could be made by fitting one to the other.

On September 13, then, I registered for the convention, and the next day I registered at the employment clearinghouse. With my usual Asimovian flare for relying on lofty principles when that was not advisable, I added to the card on which I listed my vital statistics and my qualifications the totally unnecessary note: "Not interested in any work having any connection with the atomic bomb."

This was stupid, since no one was likely to offer me such work, and if anyone did, I could always have turned it down. As it was, I made myself seem like a trouble-making radical, and you can guess the result. Throughout the entire five days of the convention, I received not one call to an interview—not one. I drew a complete blank.

On September 15, however, as I was walking through the lobby of the hotel, I noticed approaching me from one side none other than Milton Silverman, one of my boon companions at Columbia before World War II, and from the other, Al Cooper, with whom I had studied for desperate hours prior to my second and successful try at the Qualifyings. We met in a three-point coalescence.

It made for an excited afternoon of being brought up to date. All three of us were now married, but Silverman and Cooper each had a child. Furthermore, each lived in Queens, each had a job, and each was dissatisfied with his job. I felt a little backward and embarrassed at still being in school.

I persuaded Silverman to get his wife, and Gertrude and I took them both to dinner and had them spend the evening at our apartment. The next day I spent with Cooper. He got one call for an interview.